

part is “what you see is what you get” and even experimenting with the different effects, cuts and transitions can help you learn, the same doesn’t hold true for audio editing. Since all the changes made have to be observed via factors like sound quality and hardware used to listen, greater sensitivity is a must. Although basic features like boosting volume, cutting out errors and sound artifacts can be done by anyone, the real craft of audio editing is learned through a non-technology medium where you need to know how terms like “gain”, “reverb”, “echo” and “pass” (among others) fit into your needs. Since the software allows you to edit these, and many other, subtle features, a deeper understanding of sound engineering is necessary and beyond the purview of this discussion.

As far as the layout is concerned for basic functionality you find that the majority of the screen real estate, apart from the obligatory Title Bar and Menu Options, is dedicated to the digital manipulation of your audio files. However in terms of consistency of layout across different software we find that audio editing suites can vary greatly. The Adobe Audition and Avid Pro Tools interfaces for example can vary greatly in terms of panel distribution and location or display of tools. While other tools like FL Studio and Sony Acid offer a completely different layout for not only editing audio files but also composing digital music. The best way to approach basic digital audio editing in this case is through the workflow approach and consider the bare necessary tools required to edit audio files.

The essential parts of any audio editing tools are usually the following - Playback Control, Volume Control (Input and Output), Editing Toolbox, Navigation Tools and the Timeline or Track area. where the file is edited. At the very onset the audio file needs to be imported into the software either through drag and drop or the import option in the Menu Bar. Depending on whether you’re editing a single audio file or a batch that needs to be edited together, the process may differ.

Importing the required audio files to your Bin is the first step and allows you to organise and label them as per your needs. The next step is similar to video editing where you have to trim out the parts of the audio file and place them into a single Track. The Playback Control allows you to run the Timeline and experience your final output. You can layer audio files over each other to create a rich “wall of sound”, which the process whereby professional music and movie compositions are done. In this process, every instrument and sound effect is edited in an individual Track and then layered over each other. Using this method you can individually tweak the